Investigating the Differences in Inspired & Expired Air

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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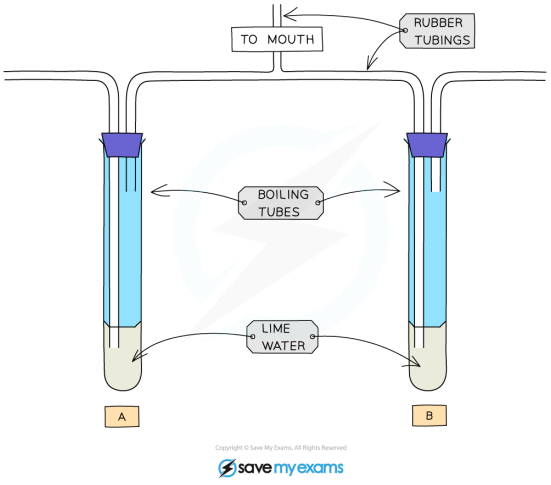
Updated on 25 September 2024

Investigating the Differences in Inspired & Expired Air

- A simple experimental setup can be used to investigate the differences between inspired and expired air



The limewater test

- When we breathe in, the air is drawn through boiling tube A
- When we breathe out, the air is blown into boiling tube B
- **Lime water** is **clear** but becomes **cloudy** (or milky) when carbon dioxide is bubbled through it
- The lime water in **boiling tube A will remain clear**, but the limewater in **boiling tube B will become cloudy**
- This shows us that the **percentage of carbon dioxide in exhaled air is higher than in inhaled air**

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